



DEPARTMENT OF REGULATORY AGENCIES

Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission

COMBATIVE SPORTS RULES AND REGULATIONS

4 CCR 740-1

[Editor's Notes follow the text of the rules at the end of this CCR Document.]

1.1 AUTHORITY

These regulations are adopted pursuant to the authority in sections 12-110-102(3), 12-110-107, and 12-110-110(3)(b), C.R.S., and are intended to be consistent with the requirements of the State Administrative Procedures Act, sections 24-4-101 *et seq.* (the "APA"), C.R.S., and the Colorado Professional Boxing Safety Act, sections 12-110-101 *et seq.* (the "Practice Act"), C.R.S.

1.2 SCOPE AND PURPOSE

These regulations shall govern the process to become licensed as a participant, official, judge, referee, promoter, or second and shall govern all permitted events in the state of Colorado.

1.3 APPLICABILITY

These Rules apply to all combative sports events where purses or prizes may or may not be given.

The standards and regulations incorporated by reference may be examined at the Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado 80202, during normal business hours, Monday through Friday, except when such days are state holidays. Certified copies of the incorporated standards shall be provided at cost upon request. The Director or the Director's designee will provide information regarding how the incorporated standards and regulations may be examined at any state public depository library. The standards and regulations are also available from the agency, organization or association originally issuing the code, standard, guideline or rules as follows: Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024,)) and the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing> (effective July 26, 2017)). This rule does not include any later amendments or editions of the code, standard, guideline, or rules.

1.4 GENERAL RULES

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-110-107 and 12-110-104, C.R.S.

A. DEFINITIONS

1. **Bout.** Match, exhibition or contest between two participants involving a combative sport.
2. **Chief Inspector.** An official assigned to carry out all duties as assigned by the Director.
3. **Combative sport.** Boxing, kickboxing, mixed martial arts, and martial arts.
4. **Commission.** The Colorado Commission of Combative Sports.

5. **Commission representative:** The Director or an official.
6. **Director.** The Director of the Colorado Office of Combative Sports.
7. **Director Approved Sanctioning Organization.** A nationally, internationally, regionally, state or tribal organization approved by the Director that may rank participants within each weight class or sanctions and approves contests or bouts in those weight classes.
8. **Division Director.** Director of the Division of Professions and Occupations, within the Colorado Department of Regulatory Agencies.
9. **Elimination Fighter.** A participant who has never received or competed for a purse.
10. **Event.** A compilation of bouts that occur at one location during a single day.
11. **Fraud.** Any licensee who cheats, obtains money or some other benefit, or misrepresents facts by deliberate and willful deception.
12. **Kick.** A strike using the foot or feet.
13. **Official.** Any person who performs an official function during the supervision of a contest or exhibition. This includes referees, judges, timekeepers and inspectors.
14. **Martial Art.** Includes by way of example and not limited to: aikido, judo, jujitsu, karate, kendo, kung fu, sumo wrestling, t' ai chi, tae kwon do, wrestling, or Muay Thai.
15. **Mixed Martial Art.** Any physical contact bout between two or more individuals who attempt to outscore, knock out, or gain submission of the opponent by using any combination of boxing, kicking, choking techniques, or martial art.
16. **Muay Thai.** Any physical bout between two individuals striking with the hand, knee, elbow and any part of the leg including the feet to outscore, knock out or otherwise disable an opponent into submission. Muay Thai shall also include the use of sweeps to off balance an individual.
17. **Non-Sanctioned organization.** Is an organization that is not governed by a state or tribal athletic Commission.
18. **Promoter.** Any person, association, corporation, or organization licensed to promote events.
19. **Purse.** A bout earning, a financial guarantee or any other remuneration for which participants are participating in a contest or exhibition and includes the participant's share of any payment received for radio broadcasting, television or motion picture rights.
20. **Recognized Sanctioning Organization.** A National Olympic Committee recognized and in good standing with the International Olympic Committee.
21. **Reinstatement.** The process by which an expired license is returned to Active status.
22. **Renewal.** The process of retaining an active license in accordance with the schedule established by the Division Director pursuant to sections 12-110-109 and 12-20-202, C.R.S.

23. **Sanctioned Organization.** An organization that sanctions bouts of boxing, kickboxing, Muay Thai or mixed martial arts or martial arts by a state or tribal athletic Commission that has filed a permit and their rules for approval.
24. **Sponsoring Organization.** A national or international organization generally recognized in their community and which: may rank participants within each weight class or sanctions and approves bouts in those weight classes.

C. VIOLATIONS OF RULES

Violations of any provision of these Rules may result in immediate ejection from event, a ban from future events and subject the licensee to disciplinary action.

D. RESPONSIBILITY

All promoters, participants, corners and officials associated with combative sport events shall acquaint themselves with and comply with all applicable laws and rules of the Commission.

E. IMPROPER CONDUCT, FOUL OR ABUSIVE LANGUAGE EJECTION

1. The use of foul or abusive language or mannerisms or threats of physical harm by any person at any permitted event shall not be tolerated. This includes all press conferences, weigh-ins and any aspect of an event. In addition, prohibited conduct includes unfair dealings, unsportsmanlike conduct, protesting the decisions of the officials, or violating any laws or rules.
2. If improper conduct occurs at any permitted event, the Director or chief inspector may eject the individual and forbid such person from acting in any capacity in connection with that or any subsequent permitted event. Any licensee who refuses to obey an order by the Director or chief inspector to leave the premises because of conduct prohibited in this paragraph, or any person who returns to the premises in violation of the Director's or chief inspector's order may be subject to further disciplinary action.

F. MODIFICATION OF BOUT RESULT

1. Should the Director determine one or more of the following factors exist, the Director may request a hearing on a result modification matter:
 - a. Indications of collusion affecting the result of the bout are present;
 - b. The compilation of the scorecards of the judges disclosed an error which showed that the decision was given to the wrong participant;
 - c. An error interpreting the rules that may have resulted in an incorrect decision or that improper referee mechanics contributed to an incorrect stoppage; or
 - d. A positive test result reveals the use of a prohibited drug, substance, or method.
- b. In determining whether to modify a bout result, the Director may consider any relevant information submitted. The Director may also use any additional outside opinions or resources to determine the modification of any results.

G. LIMITED USE OF INSTANT REPLAY

The use of instant replay shall be limited to the below criteria:

1. Should the Director approve the use of instant replay prior to an event, only the referee may determine if the use of instant replay is indicated.
2. The referee shall only use instant replay for the purpose of determining if a foul was committed that caused a "bout ending sequence" that brought about the final end of the fight.
3. Based on the instant-replay review, the referee may make the final call with respect to the bout that could result in one of the following decisions: a winner of the bout; a "no-contest" determination; a disqualification; or a technical decision by the judges.

H. SANCTIONING ORGANIZATIONS

1. Combative sports events, contests or bouts sanctioned by organizations recognized as a National Olympic Committee by the International Olympic Committee are Recognized Sanctioning Organizations and approved by the Director without any additional requirements. Combative sports events, contests or bouts sponsored by a Recognized Sanctioning Organization do not meet the definition of tough-person fighting under section 12-110-104(16)(a), C.R.S. It is the responsibility of the committee to notify the Director if the committee is no longer recognized as a National Olympic Committee by the International Olympic Committee within 30 days of their change in status.
2. Combative sports events, contests or bouts not sanctioned by an organization recognized as a National Olympic Committee by the International Olympic Committee must submit the organization's by-laws and rules for review by the Director. If approved by the Director, the organization will be deemed a Director Approved Sanctioning Organization and may apply for a permit. A Director Recognized Sanctioning Organization does not meet the definition of tough-person fighting under section 12-110-104(16)(a), C.R.S. It is the responsibility of the organization to notify the Director of any changes to the organization's rules and re-submit them for the Director's review 30 days prior to any permitted event, contest or bout.
3. Combative sports events, contests or bouts sanctioned or sponsored by an organization not recognized as either a Recognized Sanctioning Organization or a Director Approved Sanctioning Organization are not permitted, meet the definition of tough-person fighting under section 12-110-104(16)(a), C.R.S., and are subject to disciplinary action under article 10 of Title 12 of the Colorado Revised Statutes.

I. REINSTATEMENT OF AN EXPIRED LICENSE

The purpose of this Rule is to establish the qualifications and procedures for reinstatement of an expired license pursuant to sections 12-110-109 and 12-20-105, C.R.S.

1. Conditions of Reinstatement: License expired for less than two years
 - a. An applicant seeking reinstatement of an expired license for less than two years shall complete a reinstatement application and pay a reinstatement fee.
2. Conditions of Reinstatement: License expired two years or more
 - a. An applicant seeking reinstatement of an expired license for two years or more shall complete a reinstatement application, pay a reinstatement fee and demonstrate competency for the specific position in a manner approved by the Director.

J. REPORTING CONVICTIONS, JUDGMENTS AND ADMINISTRATIVE PROCEEDINGS

1. Licensees shall notify the Director within 30 days of any of the following events:
 - a. The conviction of a felony under any state or federal law, which would be a violation of section 12-110-111, C.R.S. A guilty verdict, a plea of guilty or a plea of nolo contendere (no contest) accepted by the court is considered a conviction;
 - b. A disciplinary action imposed upon the licensee by another jurisdiction that licenses second, which would be a violation of section 12-110-111, C.R.S., including, but not limited to, a citation, sanction, probation, civil penalty, or a denial, suspension, revocation, or modification of a license whether it is imposed by consent decree, order, or other decision, for any cause other than failure to pay a license fee by the due date;
 - c. Revocation or suspension by another state athlete Commission, municipality, federal or state agency or any association who oversees combative sports;
 - d. Any judgment, award or settlement of a civil action or arbitration in which there was a final judgment or settlement against the licensee.
2. The notice to the Director shall include the following information;
 - a. If the event is an action by a governmental agency (as described above), the name of the agency, its jurisdiction, the case name, and the docket, proceeding or case number by which the event is designated, and a copy of the consent decree, order or decision;
 - b. If the event is a felony conviction, the court, its jurisdiction, the case name, the case number, a description of the matter or a copy of the indictment or charges, and any plea or verdict entered by the court. The licensee shall also provide to the Director a copy of the imposition of sentence related to the felony conviction and the completion of all terms of the sentence with 30 days of such action;
 - c. If the event concerns a civil action or arbitration proceeding, the court or arbiter, the jurisdiction, the case name, the case number, a description of the matter or a copy of the complaint, and a copy of the verdict, the court or arbitration decision, or, if settled, the settlement agreement and court's order of dismissal;
3. The licensee notifying the Director may submit a written statement with the notice to be included with the licensee's records.

K. REQUIREMENT TO NOTIFY DIRECTOR OF ADDRESS AND NAME CHANGES

1. Licensees shall inform the Director of any name, address, telephone, or email change within thirty days of the change. The Director will not change a promoter's information without explicit notification in a manner prescribed by the Director.
2. One of the following forms of documentation is needed to change a name or correct a social security number or individual taxpayer identification number:
 - a. Marriage license;
 - b. Divorce decree;

- c. Court order;
- d. Documentation from the Internal Revenue Service verifying the licensee's valid individual taxpayer identification number; or
- e. A driver's license or social security card with a second form of identification may be acceptable at the discretion of the Division Director.

1.5 REQUIREMENTS FOR PARTICIPANTS IN ALL BOUTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-20-105, 12-20-202(1) and (2), 12-110-107, 12-110-108, 12-110-109, and 12-110-111, C.R.S.

A. LICENSE TO FIGHT APPLICATIONS

A license is required for a participant to fight in a professional combative sports contest. All participants shall submit an application for a license to fight in a manner prescribed by the Division Director. Incomplete or incorrect applications will not be accepted.

B. FEES

Each applicant for a license shall pay the required fee before the license to fight is granted. The license fee schedule is established by the Division Director pursuant to section 12-20-105, C.R.S.

C. MINIMUM AGE REQUIREMENT

Any person who wishes to apply for a participant license must be a minimum age of eighteen, unless a signed verification of approval and waiver is signed by the parent or legal guardian and the Director approves.

D. FEDERAL REGISTRATION REQUIREMENT

1. Pursuant to the "Professional Boxing Safety Act of 1996" all professional boxing participants must be registered with the recognized boxing federal registry and obtain a federal identification card in order to participate in boxing bouts anywhere in the United States. Therefore, all professional boxing participants shall show proof of registration. All Mixed Martial Arts participants must register for a National Identification card.
2. Any boxing debut participant must be registered with a federal identification card within seven days prior to the first bout. The participant shall not be permitted to box in any contest scheduled for more than four rounds for the participants first four bouts and shall not be permitted to compete in any bout of more than six rounds until the participant has participated in ten or more professional bouts, unless approved by the Director.
3. Each participant will present their identification card or completed application to the Director or chief inspector no later than the scheduled time of the weigh-in for a bout. A participant, who is unable to produce their identification card or establish with the Director or chief inspector that they have a current federal identification, will not be permitted to participate in the bout.

E. WEIGH-INS AND FIGHT APPEARANCE

1. Each participant must be weighed in the presence of a Commission representative as designated by the Director, on scales approved by the Director and at a place designated by the Director. Except for fight attire, participants must have all items of weight stripped from their body before they are weighed in. All participants shall appear at the weigh-in and event on time as required by the Director. All participants must report to the Director or chief inspector as soon as they arrive to the weigh-in and event at a place designated by the Director. Failure to report to the Director or chief inspector on time may disqualify the participant from competing and may subject the participant to disciplinary action. Unless a championship bout, participants' weights will be rounded down to the nearest pound. The weigh-in shall be no less than six hours and no more than 36 hours prior to the scheduled event. The Director may require participants to be weighed more than once for major bouts/events.
2. Participants are not allowed to leave the designed weigh-in area until such time as they are notified by the Director or the chief inspector.
3. Participants shall be given one hour from the designated time to weigh in, unless otherwise approved by the Director. Failure to weigh in within the designated time frame may result in the bout being cancelled. No pre-weight checks may be done on the official scale prior to or during the weigh in period.
4. Participants missing weight during the initial one-hour period may be given an additional hour to make weight, provided that a Colorado licensed physician is present. The additional time shall start when the Director or Commission representative records the participants initial weight.

F. FAILURE TO MAKE CONTRACTED WEIGHT

A participant who at the scheduled time of weigh-in fails to meet the weight specified in the contract between the promoter and the participant may be disqualified from competing and may be subject to disciplinary action.

G. PARTICIPANTS' APPEARANCE

1. Participants shall not be permitted to have excessive petroleum jelly, grease or foreign substances on any part of their body.
2. Participants' hair shall be cut or arranged in such a manner as not to interfere with the participant's vision. Hair may be secured using rubber bands or other banding devices but not hairpins or hairnets. The hair must be free of all hair styling products (e.g., mousse, gel, or spray).
3. The Director or chief inspector shall determine whether head or facial hair (e.g., mustaches, goatees, sideburns) or hair length, or hair adornments (e.g. jewelry or other decorative items) presents any potential hazard to the safety of the participants, or may interfere with the supervision and conduct of the bout. The participant may not compete in the bout unless the circumstance creating the potential hazard or interference is corrected to the satisfaction of the Director or chief inspector.
4. Participants are prohibited from wearing facial or body adornments such as earrings, jewelry or body piercing accessories during the bout.

5. Any non-approved objects on or about the body of the participant during the bout may disqualify the participant.

H. APPROVED RING APPAREL

1. Participants in an event shall prepare themselves with appropriate ring apparel for the sport as approved by an official.
2. Male participants may be required to wear an abdominal guard, a protective cup, and have two pairs of trunks of contrasting color and shoes.
3. Female participants must wear a short sleeved (above the elbow), or sleeveless, form-fitting style top, breast protector, or sports bra. Loose fitting tops are a safety risk and shall not be permitted. Wrestling singlets are not permitted. Female competitors may also be required to have two pairs of trunks of contrasting color and shoes.

I. MOUTHPIECE REQUIREMENTS / FOREIGN OBJECTS

1. Participants are required to wear an approved, and properly fitted mouthpiece during competition. The round shall not begin without the proper placement of the mouthpiece. If the mouthpiece is dislodged during competition, the referee will call time and have the mouthpiece replaced at the first available opportunity, without interfering with the immediate action. Points may be deducted from the participant or the participant may be disqualified if the mouthpiece is purposely dislodged or if the mouthpiece continuously becomes dislodged.
2. Participants must bring two approved and properly fitted mouth guards to the bout.
3. Participants are prohibited from having any removable object other than the required mouthpiece in their mouth during competition. Participants are subject to inspection before, during or after a bout. Should the Director or chief inspector find any foreign object in a participant's mouth, the participant may be subject to disciplinary action.

J. HAND WRAP REQUIREMENTS

1. Hand wraps shall be applied in the dressing room in the presence of a Commission representative. Unless a championship bout, a representative of a participant must request in writing at the weigh-in or prior, to witness the wrapping of the opponent's hands.
2. White adhesive tape of no more than six feet and not over one and one-half inches wide can be placed directly on the hand to protect the hand near the wrist. The tape may cross the back of the hand but shall not extend within one inch of the knuckles when the hand is clenched in a fist. A single four-inch by four-inch white surgical pad or equivalent material must be approved by the Director or the chief inspector.
3. If equivalent material is approved it must be folded in half and may be used on the knuckles of each hand for added protection and safety.
4. Single strips of tape not wider than one-fourth inch and not longer than three inches may be placed between the knuckles in order to hold the white gauze in place.

5. Participants shall use soft white surgical bandage not over two inches wide and twenty yards in length, held in place by not more than six feet of white surgeon's adhesive tape to complete the wrappings for each hand. Bandages shall be adjusted in the dressing room in the presence of a Commission representative, who must sign across the back of the hand before gloves are secured on each participant.

6. Approved tape/gauze of all brands may be allowed with Director approval.

K. GLOVE REQUIREMENTS

1. The participant or the second is responsible for ensuring that gloves are not twisted or manipulated in any way. If a glove breaks or a string becomes untied during the bout, the referee will instruct the timekeeper to take time out while the glove is corrected. All gloves will be checked by a Commission representative prior to the start of a bout and any snagged, torn, or unfit gloves will not be approved for competition.
2. Participants must decide on the gloves the participant expects to use during the bout. After the Director or chief inspector approves the gloves, there shall not be any changes unless or until the gloves are damaged and/or deemed unusable. Any additional gloves must also be approved by the Director prior to their use.

L. PROHIBITED SUBSTANCES

All participants are prohibited from using any drugs, alcohol, or stimulants, which could either impair or enhance their fight performance. The consumption of any substance other than plain water is prohibited during the event.

M. DELAY OF BOUTS

Participants shall be ready to enter the ring, cage, or competition area immediately prior to the start of their bout. Any participant, corner person or promoter causing a delay of more than five minutes when called may be subject to disciplinary action.

N. PARTICIPANTS DENIED PERMISSION TO FIGHT

1. The Director may deny or suspend permission for a participant to fight due to:
 - a. Medical or other non-disciplinary reasons as set forth in the "Professional Boxing Safety Act of 1996;"
 - b. Administrative or other non-disciplinary actions imposed by another state regulatory body; or
 - c. A determination by the Director that the participant is unfit to fight due to a physical or mental condition.
2. Denials and suspensions for medical, administrative or other non-disciplinary reasons may be lifted when a participant furnishes proof:
 - a. Of a sufficiently improved medical, physical, or mental health condition; or
 - b. That a suspension was not, or is no longer, merited by the facts.
3. The Director may consult with and report to the national record keeper all non-disciplinary medical and administrative denials or suspensions.

O. OUT OF STATE SUSPENSIONS

The Commission may recognize and enforce any suspension ordered by another state or tribal Commission. Participants must provide verification of license status prior to a bout. Acceptable verification of license status includes but is not limited to a current official record approved by the Director showing that the participant is not on suspension or verification that the participant is not listed on the record keepers' database.

P. PARTICIPANTS WHO ENGAGE IN NON-SANCTIONED BOUTS

1. Any participant who engages in a bout that is not sanctioned by a state or tribal athletic Commission will not be approved to compete in a sanctioned bout for a minimum of 30 days from the date of the participant's last non-sanctioned bout. The participant is responsible for obtaining a written clearance from any treating physician.
2. Any participant who wishes to engage in a sanctioned bout within 30 days from the date of the participant's last non-sanctioned bout must submit, within ten days of the non-sanctioned bout, written information that demonstrates that the non-sanctioned bout meets all the requirements set forth in these Rules for a similar type of bout.
3. A participant who engages in a non-sanctioned bout while on suspension from a state or tribal athletic Commission may be required to provide written clearance from any treating physician before the participant is approved to compete.

Q. ADDITIONAL REQUIREMENTS OF FEMALE PARTICIPANTS

1. Pregnancy Test

Participants shall submit a doctor's written verification of a negative pregnancy test dated within seven days of a scheduled event. The cost of the test is the responsibility of the participant.

1.6 REQUIREMENTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. NUMBER OF BOUTS

The Director has the discretion to control and limit the number of bouts held in any one event. Bouts in which more than two participants appear in the ring or cage at the same time will not be approved.

B. BOUT REVIEW

The Director may refuse to permit a bout to proceed upon a determination that either or both participants should not compete because of one or more of the following factors:

1. Skill level and ability of their opponent;
2. Age disparity between opponents;
3. Consecutive losses or wins on recent record;
4. Fighting history, including recent TKO's or KO's;

5. Disqualifications and/or poor performances;
6. Recent injuries;
7. Failure to appear at any scheduled weigh-in or event;
8. Failure to compete at any event;
9. Request of a weight that may be unattainable given weight history, build, or physique;
10. Failing to make weight;
11. Lack of experience with consecutive rounds or bouts;
12. Medical test results;
13. Professional debut participants verification that they have trained for a minimum of 30 days prior to bout approval;
14. Recent positive drug or substance test or any known positive test result;
15. Failure to submit to a drug test in any jurisdiction;
16. Physical impairment(s), eye blindness, missing limb;
17. Serious head or brain injury, trauma, impact or damage;
18. Age and date of most recent bout;
19. Overall physical and mental fitness;
20. Any action by any athletic or combative sports Commission in any jurisdiction;
21. History of bad faith or dealings with any promotions or Commissions;
22. Not completing the bout requirements in a timely manner;
23. Conduct that discredits or tends to discredit any sport regulated by the Commission in which the participant is competing;
24. Any related Medical condition that affects a participants' ability to fight.

C. PRE-FIGHT PHYSICAL EXAMINATIONS

1. Participants must submit to a physical examination performed by a licensed physician and be declared fit to compete prior to the bout at a time approved by the Director. Any participant deemed to be unfit to participate by the licensed physician will not be permitted to compete. In such instances, the promoter will be notified immediately by the Director or the Chief Official.
2. Promoters are responsible for providing a suitable place for Physicians to conduct the physical examinations. The Director may require additional medical tests prior to the weigh-in and must reject a participant for test results that are incomplete or unsatisfactory or deemed untimely prior to the weigh-in.

3. Examination Requirements

Participants must submit to a complete physical examinations which must include, at a minimum, examinations of the following: weight, temperature, pulse (sitting and standing), lungs, blood pressure, heart, or communicable diseases, urine analysis (when deemed necessary), scrotal evidence of hernia, and general physical condition. See Rule 2.16 for additional female participant examinations.

D. MEDICAL TESTS AND RESULTS

1. All participants must submit to acceptable HIV, Hepatitis B and Hepatitis C testing within a timeframe prescribed by the Director and must provide the negative results no later than 48 hours prior to weigh in. Exceptions may be made for substitutions as determined by the Director. The Director may on a case by case basis require additional medical tests for participants.
2. All results must contain the participants name, date of birth, and collection date.
3. Additional Test Requirements for Participants age 45 and Older.
 - a. Participants age 45 and older who have not been routinely fighting in permitted events for the past five years must undergo the following additional tests or examinations.
 - (1) General physical examination and Senior Athletes Fitness Examination (SAFE), to include a routine EKG and/or any other tests recommended by the physician.

E. POST FIGHT SUSPENSIONS

1. The ringside physician shall impose a medical suspension or a mandatory rest period on each participant after a bout. If the ringside physician imposes a suspension less than the minimum required under this rule, the Director shall increase the suspension to the minimum amount set forth in this rule.
 - a. Mandatory minimum seven (7) day rest period for participants who have competed in a bout and have not suffered any physical injury or in bouts of three (3) to five (5) rounds, where no physical injury, based on the post-fight physical.
 - b. Minimum twenty-one (21) day rest period for participants who have competed in bouts of six (6) to (9) rounds.
 - c. Minimum thirty (30) day rest period for participants who have competed in bouts of ten (10) rounds or more.
 - d. If a participant has incurred a technical knockout from blows to the head, a medical suspension for a period of not less than thirty (30) days.
 - e. If a participant has incurred a knockout from blows to the head, a medical suspension for a period of not less than sixty (60) days.
 - f. If a participant has suffered two (2) knockouts or technical knockouts from blows to the head within a six (6) month period, a medical suspension for a period of not less than sixty (60) days.

- g. If a participant has suffered three (3) knockouts or technical knockouts from blows to the head within a one (1) year period, a medical suspension for a period of not less than one hundred and eighty (180) days.
 - h. If a participant has suffered a technical knockout or the bout is stopped due to cuts, a medical suspension for a period of not less than thirty (30) days.
- 1. The ringside physician or Director in consultation with a Commission appointed physician may impose an indefinite medical suspension which shall be removed only at the satisfaction and in consultation with a physician member appointed to the Commission upon subsequent medical examination.
- 2. A participant shall not take part in any bout or sparring activities during the period of the medical suspension or mandatory rest period.
- 3. All medical suspension and/or mandatory rest period suspension shall be documented on the appropriate Commission form.
- 4. A participant may appeal a medical suspension to the Director by:
 - a. Furnishing proof that the medical or physical condition has significantly improved; or
 - b. Furnishing proof that the suspension was not, or is no longer, merited by facts.
- 5. Prior to lifting any medical suspension, all provided documentation shall be reviewed by a Commission doctor who shall provide a recommendation, in writing, to lift the suspension.

F. PARTICIPANTS NOT SAFE TO COMPETE

Participants cannot safely engage or compete in a bout where there is the potential of an unfair advantage over their opponent. As such, if a participant has one or more medical conditions, the participant may not safely engage in combative sport activities and may not be permitted to compete. Such medical conditions will be reviewed by the Director after consultation with the licensed physician on a case by case basis.

G. ADVANCED NOTIFICATION, RANDOM, OR FOR-CAUSE TESTING OF PARTICIPANTS

- 1. **Noticed Testing:** All participants in bouts designated by the Director will be notified in advance that they will be tested for the use of any prohibited drugs, substances and methods identified by the World Anti-Doping Agency. If the Director determines that testing of the participants should occur, promoters may be verbally informed before the conclusion of the weigh-in.
- 2. **Random Testing:** All participants scheduled to compete on any upcoming event are subject to random testing for the use of any prohibited drugs, substances and methods identified by the World Anti-Doping Agency. Random testing shall be conducted in accordance with a process established by the Director.
- 3. **For Cause Testing:** If the Director has reason to believe that a participant scheduled to compete on any upcoming event may be under the influence of any prohibited drugs, substances and methods identified by the World Anti-Doping Agency, the Director may order testing of the participant to determine whether or not the participant has taken, used or ingested any drugs, substances and methods.

4. **Mandatory Testing:** Testing will be mandatory for participants in bouts determined by the Director to be championship bouts.
5. All testing identified above shall be conducted at the discretion of the Director. In any bout which the Director believes the interest of a combative sport so require, the Director may order both participants submit to testing.
6. **Prohibited drugs, substances and methods:** The Commission hereby adopts the edition, effective January 1, 2022, of the Prohibited List – International Standard published by the World Anti-Doping Agency. This Prohibited List is adopted to provide notice of this code to all participants. This Rule does not include later amendments to or editions of the Prohibited List of the World Anti-Doping Agency.

Notwithstanding this rule, cannabinoids are not a prohibited substance.

A copy of the Prohibited List published by the World Anti-Doping Agency is available for public inspection during regular business hours at the Commission office at the Division of Professions and Occupations, Department of Regulatory Agencies, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado, 80202, and at any state publications depository and distribution center. For further information regarding how this material can be obtained or examined, contact the Director for the Commission at 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado, 80202, 303-894-7800. The Prohibited List may be obtained, free of charge, at the Internet address www.wada-ama.org. Address: Stock Exchange Tower, 800 Place Victoria (Suite 1700), PO Box 120, Montreal, Quebec H47 1B7, Canada.

H. CHAMPIONSHIP BOUTS

A bout shall not be advertised, promoted or called a championship bout unless it has the specific approval of the Commission. A promoter shall not advertise any participant in the State of Colorado as a champion or contender in any manner that is false or misleading.

I. PROFESSIONAL-AMATEUR BOUTS PROHIBITED

Bouts between professionals and amateurs are prohibited. Nothing in this Rule would prohibit combined Professional-Amateur Events.

1.7 DECLARATORY ORDERS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-110-107 and 24-4-105(11), C.R.S., and establishes procedures for the handling of requests for declaratory orders.

- A. Any person or entity may petition the Commission for a declaratory order to terminate controversies or remove uncertainties as to the applicability of any statutory provision or of any Rule or order of the Commission.
- B. The Commission will determine, at its discretion and without notice to petitioner, whether to rule upon any such petition. If the Commission determines that it will not rule upon such a petition, the Commission shall promptly notify the petitioner of its action and state the reasons for such decision.
- C. In determining whether to rule upon a petition filed pursuant to this Rule, the Commission will consider the following matters, among others:

1. Whether a ruling on the petition will terminate a controversy or remove uncertainties as to the applicability to petitioner of any statutory provisions or rule or order of the Commission.
 2. Whether the petition involves any subject, question or issue that is the subject of a formal or informal matter or investigation currently pending before the Commission or a court involving one or more petitioners.
 3. Whether the petition involves any subject, question or issue that is the subject of a formal or informal matter or investigation currently pending before the Commission or a court but not involving any petitioner.
 4. Whether the petition seeks a ruling on a moot or hypothetical question or will result in an advisory ruling or opinion.
 5. Whether the petitioner has some other adequate legal remedy, other than an action for declaratory relief pursuant to the Colorado Rules of Civil Procedure 57, which will terminate the controversy or remove any uncertainty as to the applicability to the petitioner of the statute, rule or order in question.
- D. Any petition filed pursuant to this Rule shall set forth the following:
1. The name and address of the petitioner and whether the petitioner is licensed pursuant to Title 12, Article 110.
 2. The statute, rule or order to which the petition relates.
 3. A concise statement of all of the facts necessary to show the nature of the controversy or uncertainty and the manner in which the statute, rule, or order in question applies or potentially applies to the petitioner.
- E. If the Commission determines that it will rule on the petition, the following procedures shall apply:
1. The Commission may rule upon the petition based solely upon the facts presented in the petition. In such a case:
 - a. Any ruling of the Commission will apply only to the extent of the facts presented in the petition and any amendment to the petition.
 - b. The Commission may order the petitioner to file a written brief, memorandum or statement of position.
 - c. The Commission may set the petition, upon due notice to petitioner, for a non-evidentiary hearing.
 - d. The Commission may dispose of the petition on the sole basis of the matters set forth in the petition.
 - e. The Commission may request the petitioner to submit additional facts in writing. In such event, such additional facts will be considered as an amendment to the petition.

- f. The Commission may take administrative notice of facts pursuant to the Administrative Procedure Act at section 24-4-105(8), C.R.S., and may utilize its experience, technical competence, and specialized knowledge in the disposition of the petition.
 - 2. If the Commission rules upon the petition without a hearing, it shall promptly notify the petitioner of its decision.
 - 3. The Commission may, at its discretion, set the petition for hearing, upon due notice to petitioner, for the purpose of obtaining additional facts or information or to determine the truth of any facts set forth in the petition or to hear oral argument on the petition. The notice to the petitioner shall set forth, to the extent known, the factual or other matters into which the Commission intends to inquire.
 - 4. For the purpose of such a hearing, to the extent necessary, the petitioner shall have the burden of proving all the facts stated in the petition; all of the facts necessary to show the nature of the controversy or uncertainty; and the manner in which the statute, rule, or order in question applies or potentially applies to the petitioner and any other facts the petitioner desires the Commission to consider.
- F. The parties to any proceeding pursuant to this Rule shall be the Commission and the petitioner. Any other person including the Director may seek leave of the Commission to intervene in such a proceeding and leave to intervene will be granted at the sole discretion of the Commission. A petition to intervene shall set forth the same matters as are required by Section 4.4 of this Rule. Any reference to a "petitioner" in this Rule also refers to any person who has been granted leave to intervene by the Commission.
- G. Any declaratory order or other order disposing of a petition pursuant to this Rule shall constitute agency action subject to judicial review pursuant to the Colorado Administrative Procedures Act at section 24-4-106, C.R.S.

1.8 REQUIREMENTS FOR BOXING PARTICIPANTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. WEIGHT ALLOWANCES

Before a participant will be permitted to fight an opponent, who exceeds the weight allowance as shown, the participant must first receive approval by the Director:

POUNDS	CLASSIFICATION	ALLOWANCE
191+	Heavyweight	No limit
176-190	Cruiserweight	15 lbs.
169-175	Light Heavyweight	8 lbs.
161-168	Super Middleweight	8 lbs.
155-160	Middleweight	7 lbs.
148-154	Junior Middleweight	7 lbs.
141-147	Welterweight	7 lbs.
136-140	Junior Welterweight	5 lbs.
131-135	Lightweight	5 lbs.
127-130	Junior Lightweight	5 lbs.
123-126	Featherweight	5 lbs.
119-122	Junior Featherweight	5 lbs.
116-118	Bantamweight	5 lbs.
113-115	Junior Bantamweight	5 lbs.
109-112	Flyweight	5 lbs.
106-108	Junior Flyweight	5 lbs.
Below 105	Minimum Weight	5 lbs.

B. NUMBER AND DURATION OF ROUNDS

A bout will have a maximum of ten rounds with the exception of a championship bout, as determined by the Director, which may not exceed twelve rounds. Three minutes will constitute a round, with a rest period of one minute between rounds, which may be extended at the discretion of the Director. The timekeeper shall give warning to the seconds by suitable signal ten seconds before the beginning or the ending of each round.

Notwithstanding this rule and with prior Director approval, three-minute rounds shall constitute a round for all female bouts.

C. PARTICIPATION RESTRICTIONS

Any participant, who has participated in a bout scheduled for four or more rounds, shall not participate in another bout for at least seven days unless specifically authorized by the Director.

D. RING OCCUPANTS

No person other than the participants and the referee shall enter the ring during the rounds. Between rounds, one corner and/or cutperson may be inside the ring and the others on the ring apron. The licensed physician may enter the ring if asked by the referee. No participant shall leave the ring during any rest period between rounds. The referee may, at their discretion, stop a bout if an unauthorized person enters the ring during a round. The Director or chief inspector may also limit unauthorized people from entering the ring at any time during and after an event.

E. INTENTIONAL FOULS

1. If an intentional foul causes an injury, and the injury is severe enough to immediately terminate a bout, the participant causing the injury shall lose by disqualification.
2. If an intentional foul causes an injury, and the bout is allowed to continue, the referee will notify the authorities and deduct two points from the participant who caused the foul. Point deductions for intentional fouls will be mandatory.

3. If an intentional foul causes an injury that results in the bout being stopped in a later round, the injured participant shall win by Technical Decision if the recipient of an intentional foul is ahead on the score cards. If the injured participant is behind or even on the score cards, the bout will result in a Technical Draw.
4. If a participant injures themselves while attempting to intentionally foul their opponent, the referee will not take any action in their favor, and this injury is the same as one produced by a fair blow. If a participant has conducted themselves in an unsportsmanlike manner, the referee may stop the bout and disqualify the participant.

F. UNINTENTIONAL FOULS

1. If an unintentional foul causes an injury severe enough to immediately stop the bout before three completed rounds or four complete rounds for a championship bouts, the bout will result in a No Contest.
2. If an unintentional foul causes an injury severe enough to immediately stop the bout after three completed rounds and four rounds for championship bouts have occurred, the bout will result in a Technical Decision awarded to the participant who is ahead on the score cards at the time the bout is stopped. Partial or incomplete rounds will be scored.
3. If the judge(s) believes that a participant did not engage in any action, the round should be scored as an even round at the discretion of the judges. A fighter who is hit with an accidental low blow must continue after a reasonable amount of time but no more than five minutes or the participant will lose the bout by Technical Knockout (TKO).

G. TACTICS DEEMED FOULS

1. Hitting below the belt or after the bell has terminated the round;
2. Hitting an opponent who is down or who is getting up after being down;
3. Holding an opponent or deliberately maintaining a clinch;
4. Holding an opponent with one hand and hitting with the other hand;
5. Butting with the head or shoulder or using a knee;
6. Hitting with the glove laces or the heel of the hand, the wrist, or elbow and any back-hand blows;
7. Hitting or flicking with an open glove, or thumbing;
8. Wrestling, hitting on the break or pushing an opponent;
9. Spitting out the mouthpiece or going down without being hit;
10. Striking deliberately the part of the body over the kidneys;
11. Use of a pivot or rabbit punch;
12. Hitting an opponent during intervention by the referee;
13. Hitting an opponent who is entangled in the ropes;

14. Biting or any unsportsmanlike conduct;
15. Abusive or profane language;
16. Failure to obey the referee;
17. Any physical action which may injure a participant, except by fair sportsmanlike boxing; and
18. Passive defense by means of double cover.

H. PENALTY FOR FOULS

1. The referee may penalize a participant if they commit a foul.
2. Points may be deducted from the participant's score in the round or rounds such foul occurred. The referee shall notify the judges at the time of the foul and verify between rounds of the points deducted.
3. If a foul is of a serious nature, intentionally inflicted, or is continuous or repeated. The referee may award the bout to the participant who is fouled.

I. DETERMINATION OF A KNOCKDOWN

1. A knockdown will be ruled when a participant is hit with the padded knuckle part of the glove on the front or side of the head or the front or side of the body above the belt, and any part of the participant's body other than feet falls to the floor; or the participant is hanging over the ropes without the ability to protect himself or herself and cannot fall to the floor.
2. A referee may count a participant out if the participant is on the floor or is being held up by the ropes.

J. REFEREE COUNT

1. If a participant falls due to fatigue, or is knocked down by their opponent, the participant will be allowed ten seconds to rise unassisted. When such participant falls, their opponent shall go to the farthest neutral corner and remain there while the count is made.
2. A participant shall be deemed down when any part of their body other than their feet is on the floor, or the participant is being held up by the ropes. A referee may count a participant out either on the ropes or on the floor.
3. The referee shall stop counting should the opponent fail to go to the neutral corner, and will resume the count where the participant left off when the opponent goes to the neutral corner.
4. Should a participant who is down rise before the count of ten is reached, and goes back down immediately without being struck by the opponent, the referee shall resume the count where it was left off.
5. Before a participant resumes after having been knocked, fallen or slipped to the floor, the referee shall wipe any accumulated debris from the participant's gloves.

6. When a mouthpiece is knocked out, the referee may allow the exchange to continue until there is a break in the action. Timeout shall be called and the mouthpiece rinsed and replaced.

K. PARTICIPANT'S RETURN TO RING

1. A participant shall receive a twenty second count if they are knocked out of the ring and onto the floor by a legal strike. The participant is to be unassisted by the second(s). If assisted by the second(s), the participant shall be disqualified.
2. A participant who has been wrestled, pushed, or has fallen through the ropes during a contest may be helped back by anyone and the referee shall allow reasonable time for the return.
3. When on the ring apron outside the ropes, the participant shall enter the ring immediately.
4. Should the participant stall for time outside the ropes, the referee shall start the count without waiting for the participant to reenter the ring.
5. When one participant has fallen through the ropes, the other participant shall retire to a designated corner and remain there until ordered to continue the bout.
6. A participant who deliberately wrestles or throws an opponent from the ring, or who punches their opponent when they are partly out of the ring and prevented by the ropes from assuming a position of defense may be penalized, disqualified, and subject to disciplinary action.

L. SAVED BY THE BELL

A participant who has been knocked down cannot be saved by the bell in any round.

M. THREE KNOCKDOWNS IN THE SAME ROUND – TKO

The contest may be stopped at any time by the referee to protect the health and safety of either participant. A participant who has been ruled by the referee to have been knocked down three times in the same round shall lose by TKO. The three-knockdown rule may be waived at the sole discretion of the Director.

N. BOUT TERMINATION DUE TO INJURY - TKO

If a participant sustains an injury from a fair blow and the injury is severe enough to terminate the bout, the injured participant will lose by TKO.

O. KNOCKDOWN EIGHT COUNT

1. In the case of a knockdown, the eight count is mandatory. A participant who is knocked out, or is technically knocked out shall be suspended for a minimum of thirty days from participating in any event.

1.9 REQUIREMENT FOR PROFESSIONAL KICKBOXING AND MUAY THAI PARTICIPANTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. CONDUCT OF KICKBOXING AND MUAY THAI EVENTS – RULES AND PROCEDURES

The Commission adopts by reference the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Unified Rules of Professional Kickboxing (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing/> (effective July 26, 2017)).

The standards and regulations incorporated by reference may be examined at the Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado 80202, during normal business hours, Monday through Friday, except when such days are state holidays. Certified copies of the incorporated standards shall be provided at cost upon request. The Director or the Director's designee will provide information regarding how the incorporated standards and regulations may be examined at any state public depository library. The standards and regulations are also available from the agency, organization or association originally issuing the code, standard, guideline or rules as follows: Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)) and the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing/> (effective July 26, 2017)). This rule does not include any later amendments or editions of the code, standard, guideline, or rules.

B. PROFESSIONAL MUAY THAI SCORING

1. Points will be awarded whenever the athlete strikes the opponent by Muay Thai skills such as punching, kicking, kneeing, elbowing with force that lands on target with no infringement (i.e., not being blocked).
2. Ten (10) points shall be awarded for each round and no fraction of a point may be given. The better more skilled athlete shall be awarded ten (10) points and the opponent less.
3. The steps for forwarding points shall be as follows:
 - a. An athlete wins the round when striking using more Muay Thai skill than their opponent;
 - b. An athlete wins the round when using a more forceful Muay Thai weapon than the opponent;
 - c. An athlete wins the round when showing less exhaustion than the opponent;
 - d. An athlete wins the round when showing more effect than their opponent;
 - e. An athlete wins the round when using superior and more diverse Muay Thai skill than the opponent; or
 - f. An athlete wins the round when having less infringement of the rules than their opponent.
4. The non-awarding of points shall be as follows:
 - a. Strikes that lack Muay Thai skill;
 - b. Strikes that are blocked by the opponents arms or legs;
 - c. Striking with lack of force even when those techniques have landed on target;

- d. Striking while infringing the rules.

C. TACTICS DEEMED FOULS

The following shall be deemed fouls for Muay Thai:

1. Head-butts, biting, or pressing on the opponents eyes with the thumb of the glove;
2. Striking the groin;
3. Attacking while holding the ropes or making any unfair use of the ropes;
4. Striking on the break;
5. Holding the opponent's leg and pushing more than two (2) steps in any direction without striking with any one of the Muay Thai skills; commonly referred to as "plowing;"
6. Intentionally falling down to avoid being hit while leg is held by the opponent;
7. Throwing or taking an opponent to the floor in an unauthorized manner by bending the lower back of opponent or lifting up the opponent;
8. Straight line attacks that target the knee joint;
9. Sweeps not done with the front of the shin or foot-to-foot. Hooking the back or the side of the leg is prohibited;
10. Intentional evasion of contact;
11. Holding the back of the head with one hand and punching with the other hand; commonly referred to as "dirty boxing;" and
12. Executing any techniques which are deemed malicious and beyond the scope of reasonably accepted techniques in an athletic event.

D. KNOCKDOWNS AND EIGHT COUNTS

1. In the event of a knockdown, an eight (8) count is mandatory.
2. A mandatory eight (8) count shall also be given when a participant blocks, for a sustained time, knees with one (1) or both arms folded across the abdomen or chest.
3. If a participant is knocked down three (3) times in a round and those knockdowns require an eight (8) count, the fight shall be stopped and declared a technical knockout.
4. If a participant is knocked out, or technically knocked out in two (2) consecutive bouts, the participant shall be suspended for a minimum of sixty (60) days from participating in any activity.
5. If a participant is knocked out or technically knocked out in three (3) consecutive bouts, the participant may be suspended for a minimum of one (1) year from participating in any activity.

6. The Director may require the suspended participant to undergo other medical examinations and submit proof of such examinations and physician clearance to compete in any future bouts.

E. WEIGHT ALLOWANCES

Before a participant will be permitted to fight an opponent, who exceeds the weight allowance as shown, the participant must first receive approval by the Director:

POUNDS	CLASSIFICATION	ALLOWANCE
191+	Heavyweight	No limit
176-190	Cruiserweight	15 lbs.
169-175	Light Heavyweight	8 lbs.
161-168	Super Middleweight	8 lbs.
155-160	Middleweight	7 lbs.
148-154	Junior Middleweight	7 lbs.
141-147	Welterweight	7 lbs.
136-140	Junior Welterweight	5 lbs.
131-135	Lightweight	5 lbs.
127-130	Junior Lightweight	5 lbs.
123-126	Featherweight	5 lbs.
119-122	Junior Featherweight	5 lbs.
116-118	Bantamweight	5 lbs.
113-115	Junior Bantamweight	5 lbs.
109-112	Flyweight	5 lbs.
106-108	Junior Flyweight	5 lbs.
Below 105	Minimum Weight	5 lbs.

No participant shall engage in a bout where the weight difference exceeds the allowance shown above. Any greater weight allowance requires the Director approval.

1.10 REQUIREMENTS FOR PROFESSIONAL MIXED MARTIAL ARTS (MMA) AND MARTIAL ARTS (MA) PARTICIPANTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. RULES AND PROCEDURES

The Commission adopts by reference the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports Unified Rules of Mixed Martial Arts (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/08/unified-rules-mma-july-2022.pdf> (effective July 26, 2022)).

The standards and regulations incorporated by reference may be examined at the Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado 80202, during normal business hours, Monday through Friday, except when such days are state holidays. Certified copies of the incorporated standards shall be provided at cost upon request. The Director or the Director's designee will provide information regarding how the incorporated standards and regulations may be examined at any state public depository library. The standards and regulations are also available from the agency, organization or association originally issuing the code, standard, guideline or rules as follows: Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)) and the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing> (effective July 26, 2017)). This rule does not include any later amendments or editions of the code, standard, guideline, or rules.

B. MARTIAL ARTS

1. A contest or bout of martial arts must be conducted pursuant to the official rules promulgated by the sponsoring organization for the martial art.
2. The promoter must file a copy of the official rules and a permit with the Director before approval will be given for the contest to be held.
3. Prior to the event, the Director will provide the promotor a list of specific requirements, including those concerning fouls. The promoter will be responsible for ensuring that all participants comply with the specific requirements.
4. Where applicable, provisions of Rules 1.8, 1.9, and above sections of Rule 1.10 may also constitute requirements for martial arts contests.

1.11 REQUIREMENTS FOR BAREKNUCKLE PARTICIPANTS

The Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. WEIGHT ALLOWANCES

1. Before a participant will be permitted to fight an opponent, who exceeds the weight allowance as shown, the participant must first receive written or email approval by the Director:

POUNDS	CLASSIFICATION	ALLOWANCE
266+	Super Heavyweight	No limit
226-265	Heavyweight	10 lbs.
206-225	Cruiserweight	7 lbs.
186-205	Middle Heavyweight	7 lbs.
176-185	Light Heavyweight	7 lbs.
166-175	Super Middleweight	7 lbs.
156-165	Middleweight	7 lbs.
146-155	Welterweight	5 lbs.
136-145	Lightweight	5 lbs.
126-135	Featherweight	5 lbs.
116-125	Bantamweight	5 lbs.
108-115	Flyweight	3 lbs.
100-107	Strawweight	3 lbs.

B. NUMBER AND DURATION OF ROUNDS

1. A bout shall only have a maximum of five rounds. Two minutes will constitute a round, with a rest period of one minute between rounds.
2. With prior Director approval, a bout ending in a draw at the end of the final round may continue to an additional round.
3. At no time shall an entire bareknuckle fight exceed 12 minutes, excluding any between round rest periods.

C. PARTICIPATION RESTRICTIONS

1. All Bouts shall be placed in the appropriate Federal database for tracking. Prior to approving a bout, the Director shall consider the following:
 - a. Fighter's Professional Record
 - b. Combative Sport Experience
 - c. Skill Level
 - d. Physical Condition
 - e. Current BSI assigned in BoxRec
 - f. Successive losses or wins
 - g. History of technical knockouts or knockouts
 - h. Any other factor the Director reasonably believes is appropriate.
2. Professional Debut Participants shall not enter a bareknuckle bout without prior combative sports experience.
3. Professional debut participants shall be restricted to four rounds until participants have at least four professional bouts in a sport regulated by the Commission.
4. Professional Participants with previous experience in boxing, mixed martial arts, or other Combative Sports regulated by the Commission are not considered Professional Debut Participants and can participate in any number of rounds without restriction.
5. Elimination fighters shall be prohibited from participating in any bareknuckle bout.

D. RING OCCUPANTS

1. No person other than the participants and the referee shall enter the ring during a bout. Between rounds, one corner or cut person may be inside the ring and the others on the ring apron. The licensed physician may enter the ring if asked by the referee. No participant shall leave the ring during any rest period between rounds. The referee may, at their discretion, stop a bout if an unauthorized person enters the ring during a round. The Director or chief inspector may also limit unauthorized people from entering the ring at any time during and after an event.

E. ATTIRE

1. Male participants shall not wear any form of clothing on the upper body. Upper body clothing worn by female participants must be form fitting and not loose.
2. All participants shall wear appropriate shorts, boxing shoes and mouthpiece.
3. Hair shall be secured in a manner that does not interfere with the vision or safety of any participant.
4. The wearing of jewelry is prohibited.

F. HAND WRAPS AND MOUTHPIECE

1. Hand wraps shall consist of no more than 12 yards of soft gauze bandage per hand, no more than two inches in width held in place by not more than 10 yards of surgical tape of one inch in width.
2. No tape or gauze will extend past the fighter's knuckle when clenched in a fist.
3. No tape or gauze is permitted between or on the fighter's fingers, except for the thumb which may include a single wrap of tape when the wrist is wrapped.
4. The wrapping of the wrist shall not extend more than three inches past the wrist juncture.
5. Participants are required to wear a mouthpiece and no bout may begin without one.

G. JOINT AND BODY COVERINGS

1. Other than the participant's hands, there shall be no taping, covering, or protective gear allowed on any upper portion of the body.
2. A participant may use a soft neoprene-type sleeve to cover only the knees. Approved sleeves may not have padding, velcro, plastic, metal, ties or other material considered unsafe.

H. RING REQUIREMENTS

Bareknuckle bouts shall only take place in a ring approved by the Director.

I. TACTICS DEEMED FOULS

1. Hitting the opponent below the belt,
2. Hitting an opponent who is down or is getting up after being down,
3. Maintaining the clinch without action,
4. Wrestling or kicking an opponent,
5. Putting a finger into an orifice or laceration of an opponent, including fish hooking,
6. Pulling an opponent's hair,
7. Manipulating the opponent's finger(s),

8. Striking an opponent who is helpless as the result of blows but is supported by the ropes but does not fall,
9. Butting the opponent with the head, shoulder, knee or elbow,
10. Hitting the opponent with the elbow or forearm,
11. Striking the opponent's body over the kidney,
12. Hitting the opponent on the back of the head or neck,
13. Gouging an opponent's eyes,
14. Hitting on the break, signaled by the Referee or physical act to separate,
15. Hitting an opponent after the bell,
16. Using the ropes to gain an advantage over an opponent,
17. Pushing the opponent around the fighting area or into the ropes,
18. Timidity, excessive clinching, including intentionally spitting out the mouthpiece,
19. Biting the opponent,
20. Headlocks
21. Throat punches or striking, including directing strikes towards the throat,
22. Fingers outstretched toward opponent's eyes or face,
23. Throws or takedowns,
24. Spinning backfists,
25. Hammer fists,
26. Any conduct that poses a danger to the safety of either participant, impedes fair and competitive play or is unsportsmanlike.

J. PENALTY FOR FOULS

1. The referee may penalize a participant if they commit a foul.
2. Points may be deducted from the participant's score in the round or rounds such foul occurred. The referee shall notify the judges at the time of the foul and verify between rounds of the points deducted.
3. If a foul is of a serious nature, intentionally inflicted, or is continuous or repeated. The referee may award the bout to the participant who is fouled.

K. DETERMINATION OF KNOCKDOWN

A knockdown will be ruled when a participant's body touches the mat other than the sole of their feet following a legal strike or is defenselessly hanging on/over the ropes, preventing the body from falling to the mat.

L. REFEREE COUNT

1. If a participant falls due to fatigue, or is knocked down by their opponent, the participant will be allowed ten seconds to rise unassisted. When such participant falls, their opponent shall go to the farthest neutral corner and remain there while the count is made.
2. The referee shall stop counting should the opponent fail to go to the neutral corner and will resume the count where the participant left off when the opponent goes to the neutral corner.
3. Should a participant who is down rise before the count of ten is reached and goes back down immediately without being struck by the opponent, the referee shall resume the count where it was left off.
4. Before a participant resumes after having been knocked, fallen, or slipped to the floor, the referee shall wipe any accumulated debris from the participant's gloves.
5. When a mouthpiece is knocked out, the referee may allow the exchange to continue until there is a break in the action. Timeout shall be called and the mouthpiece rinsed and replaced.
6. There is no standing eight count.

M. PARTICIPANT'S RETURN TO THE RING

1. A participant shall receive a twenty second count if they are knocked out of the ring and onto the floor by a legal strike. The participant is to be unassisted by the corner(s). If assisted by the corner(s), the participant shall be disqualified.
2. A participant who has been wrestled, pushed, or has fallen through the ropes during a contest may be helped back by anyone and the referee shall allow reasonable time for the return.
3. When on the ring apron outside the ropes, the participant shall enter the ring immediately.
4. Should the participant stall for time outside the ropes, the referee shall start the count without waiting for the participant to reenter the ring.
5. When one participant has fallen through the ropes, the other participant shall retire to a designated corner and remain there until ordered to continue the bout.
6. A participant who deliberately wrestles or throws an opponent from the ring, or who punches their opponent when they are partly out of the ring and prevented by the ropes from assuming a position of defense may be penalized, disqualified, and subject to disciplinary action.

N. SAVED BY THE BELL

1. A participant who has been knocked down cannot be saved by the bell in any round.

O. BOUT TERMINATION DUE TO INJURY – TKO

1. If a participant sustains an injury from a fair blow and the injury is severe enough to terminate the bout, the injured participant will lose by TKO.

P. THREE KNOCKDOWNS IN A ROUND

1. The contest shall be stopped by the referee to protect the health and safety of either participant. A participant who has been ruled by the referee to have been knocked down three times in the same round shall lose by TKO.

Q. SCORING

1. Judges shall score a bout based on the 10 point must system.
2. Judges shall evaluate the bout based on a priority-based system as follows:
 - a. Effective Striking based on impact/effect of legal strikes landed by a fighter,
 - b. Effective Aggressiveness based on a fighter's attempts to finish a fight,
 - c. Control of the Fighting Area based on determining who is controlling the bout's pace, place, and position.
3. Rounds shall be scored as follows:
 - a. 10-9 Round – Fighter won the round by a close of moderate margin,
 - b. 10-8 Round – Fighter won the round by a highly decisive margin (absent a knockdown),
 - c. 10-8 Round – Fighter won the round and scored a knockdown,
 - d. 10-7 Round – Fighter won the round and scored two knockdowns,
 - e. 10-6 Round - Fighter won the round and scored three knockdowns.
4. Partial or incomplete rounds shall be scored.

R. DECISIONS

A fighter may win a bout in the following manner:

1. Technical Knockout (TKO),
2. Knockout (KO),
3. Disqualification,
4. Draw,

5. No Contest – No Contest decision shall be rendered for bout that has not completed half of the scheduled rounds plus one second when stopped, including for an accidental foul causing injury that does not allow a fighter to continue.
6. Technical Decision – Technical Decision shall be rendered for a bout that has completed half of the scheduled rounds plus one second when stopped due to an accidental clash of heads, eye poke, low blow or any other unintentional foul that causes a fighter not being able to continue.

S. **ADDITIONAL PHYSICIAN REQUIREMENTS**

1. In addition to the assigned Colorado licensed ringside physician, an additional Colorado licensed Physician, Advanced Practice Nurse or Physician Assistant, shall be present that allows for timely on-site laceration repair.

T. These rules shall not apply to promotions sanctioned under Commission Rule 1.4(H).

1.12 REQUIREMENTS FOR CORNERS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-20-105, 12-110-107, 12-110-109, and 12-110-111, C.R.S.

A. **LICENSE FOR CORNERS**

A license is required in order to serve as a second in a professional combative sports contest. All corners shall submit an application for a license to assist a fighter and must be licensed at least 48 hours prior to the scheduled start of an event. Incomplete or incorrect application forms will not be accepted and will be returned to the applicant to be corrected.

B. **FEES**

Each applicant applying for a license shall pay the required fee before the license is granted. The license fee schedule is established by the Division Director pursuant to section 12-20-105, C.R.S.

C. **MINIMUM AGE REQUIREMENT**

No person under the age of eighteen years shall be licensed to act as a second.

D. **EQUIPMENT REQUIREMENTS**

Corners are required to provide all materials and equipment necessary to conduct themselves as a second. Such equipment includes water buckets, gauze and tape for hand wraps, spit buckets, scissors, towels, petroleum jelly, enswell, q-tips, mouthpieces and cut solutions. Water bottles must be clear and all hand wrapping materials must be white.

E. **NUMBER OF CORNERS**

1. Unless special permission is given by the Director, the number of corners shall not exceed three, one of whom will announce to the referee at the start of the bout that they are the chief corner. The Director may reduce the number of corners per bout or event.
2. If at any time during a bout there are more corners in a corner than allowed, the bout may be stopped until corrected or the chief corner may be disqualified and may be subject to disciplinary action.

F. ENTERING THE RING OR CAGE

Only one corner shall be inside the ring or cage between rounds. The other(s) may be on the ring platform outside the ropes. Corners shall not enter the ring until the time keeper indicates the termination of the round and they shall leave when the timekeeper gives the ten second warning before the beginning of each round. If the chief corner or another corner enters the ring before the round ends, the participant may be disqualified and the violator may be subject to disciplinary action. If there are two entrances to a cage, two corners may be in the cage at the same time.

G. CHIEF CORNER

The chief corner of a participant may stand on the ring or cage apron and attract the attention of the referee in order to end the bout. The chief corner shall not enter the ring unless the referee stops the bout and shall not interfere with a count that is in progress.

H. COACHING DURING A BOUT

While the bout is in progress, a corner shall not excessively coach a participant during a round and shall remain seated and silent when directed by the referee or a Commission representative. Corners shall not place or cause any items to be placed inside the ring or cage during a bout.

They shall not continuously stand, lean or pound on the ring apron during the round. Excessive coaching may lead to point deductions, ejection from the venue, or subject to other disciplinary action.

I. USE OF ICE/WATER AND SUBSTANCES TO STOP HEMORRHAGING

1. A participant may be refreshed with a wet sponge or spray mist bottle that only contains water.
2. Excess water or ice on the ring or cage floor shall be wiped off immediately by the corners.
3. Water discharged from the participant's mouth shall be caught in a bucket or other device furnished for that purpose.
4. A participant may not be given any stimulant.
5. Before leaving the ring or cage at the start of each round, the seconds shall remove all obstructions such as buckets, stools, bottles, towels and robes from the ring or cage floor.
6. If a participant is cut, a solution of adrenaline 1/1000, aventine, and thrombin can be used to heal the cut.
7. No other bottle or container shall be allowed or used in the corners during a bout. Any other solution or substance is prohibited.

J. APPAREL AND SUBJECT TO SEARCHES

Corners shall be neatly dressed while working the participant's corner and may be searched by a Commission representative for illegal substances or objects.

1.13 REQUIREMENTS FOR PROMOTERS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-20-105, 12-110-107, 12-110-109, and 12-110-111, C.R.S.

A. LICENSE REQUIRED

1. A license is required for a promoter of a professional combative sport contest. Promoters shall apply for a license by submitting an application in the manner prescribed by the Director and must be licensed prior to the applying for a permit. Incomplete or incorrect applications will not be accepted.
2. Promoters are responsible for ensuring that all participants and seconds are licensed and all applicable fees are paid for each event.

B. FEES

1. Each applicant for a license or permit shall pay the required fees before the license or permit is granted and based on an event with no more than 14 bouts. The license and permit fee schedules are established by the Division Director pursuant to section 12-20-105, C.R.S.
2. Promoters shall compensate officials based on geographical location and anticipated gross ticket sales as follows:

a. Area A (Denver Metro):

Gross Ticket Sales	Chief Inspector	Referee	Judges	All Other Officials
0-\$50,000	\$475.00	\$350.00	\$325.00	\$300.00
\$50,000-\$100,000	\$575.00	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$325.00
\$100,000 AND ABOVE	\$775.00	\$650.00	\$525.00	\$500.00

b. Area B (Castle Rock, Fort Collins, Colorado Springs, Greeley, Blackhawk):

Gross Ticket Sales	Chief Inspector	Referee	Judges	All Other Officials
0-\$50,000	\$495.00	\$370.00	\$345.00	\$320.00
\$50,000-\$100,000	\$595.00	\$420.00	\$370.00	\$345.00
\$100,000 AND ABOVE	\$795.00	\$670.00	\$545.00	\$520.00

c. Area C (Pueblo, Vail):

Gross Ticket Sales	Chief Inspector	Referee	Judges	All Other Officials
0-\$50,000	\$515.00	\$390.00	\$365.00	\$340.00
\$50,000-\$100,000	\$615.00	\$440.00	\$390.00	\$365.00
\$100,000 AND ABOVE	\$715.00	\$690.00	\$565.00	\$540.00

- d. Area D (Grand Junction, Glenwood Springs, Alamosa):

Gross Ticket Sales	Chief Inspector	Referee	Judges	All Other Officials
0-\$50,000	\$535.00	\$410.00	\$385.00	\$360.00
\$50,000-\$100,000	\$635.00	\$460.00	\$410.00	\$385.00
\$100,000 AND ABOVE	\$735.00	\$710.00	\$585.00	\$560.00

3. In addition to the above compensation, an event having more than 14 bouts shall require the promoter to pay an additional \$35 per fight to the Chief Inspector and an additional \$25 per fight to all other officials.

C. MINIMUM AGE REQUIREMENT

A person who applies for a promoter license must be a minimum of eighteen years old.

D. PROMOTION PERMIT AND EVENT REQUIREMENTS

1. Promotion Permit Application and Fee

- a. A promoter is required to have a permit for each event that includes a combative sport contest. A completed permit application and appropriate fee must be submitted to the Director at least thirty days prior to the scheduled date of the event.
- b. The Commission may approve a permit less than thirty days on a case by case basis.
- c. Promotion permits will not be granted to promoters who owe any fees from previous events.
- d. Any change to a previously approved permit will require a new permit application and may require a fee and must be submitted as expeditiously as possible.
- e. Permit applications filed in excess of 150 days in advance of the event require Commission approval.

2. If a promoter promotes, advertises or sell tickets for an event before the promoter is licensed and appropriate permits have been granted for the event, the promoter may be subject to a fine or disciplinary action and the license or permit may not granted.

3. Limitations and Expectations on Permits

- a. There are no limitations on the number of permits allowed at any one time. However, the Director may deny a permit for the following reasons:
 - (1) Back-to-back events;
 - (2) Same-day events;
 - (3) Inadequate number of officials to properly regulate the event;

- (4) Failure of a promoter or any person connected with the promotion to comply with any statute or rule;
- (5) A bout listed on the promotion permit application fails to meet the requirements of Rule 1.6;
- (6) Inadequate or unsafe location, site or arena selection; or,
- (7) For other reasons indicating that the requested permit may not be in the best interest of the sport, the participants, spectators, or the officials.
- (8) Failure to consult with the Director about the date prior to submitting a permit.

b. Promoters are expected to comply with the following:

- (1) Fulfill all obligations of the permit. Any promoter who cancels an event after a permit is granted may be subject to disciplinary action and future permits may be denied.
- (2) By completing the permit, promoters agree to pay in guaranteed funds all officials' fees established by the Division Director within the time frames established by the Director.
- (3) Ensure that all bouts are documented in the proper Association of Boxing Commission database for review. Failure to do so may result in the bout being cancelled.
- (4) No weigh-in will begin without official fees paid in full. If the official fees have not been paid in full, the weigh-in cannot be rescheduled and the event will be canceled.
- (5) Bout cards shall be finalized at least 48 hours prior to the weigh in date, unless otherwise approved by the Director.

4. Minimum Requirements of Rounds

- a. Promoters shall not schedule less than twenty rounds nor more than forty rounds for any one event. A standby bout shall be provided in the event an arranged bout falls through and it is necessary to put on another bout in order to meet the minimum requirements. Any exception to the number of rounds requires approval of the Director.
- b. The promoter is expected to feature a main event bout. The number of rounds that qualify as a main event bout is at least five rounds for boxing and at least three rounds for kickboxing, Muay Thai, and MMA.
- c. A promoter may appeal a permit denial to the Combative Sports Commission by submitting a written request within ten days of the denial.

E. COMPLIANCE BOND

- 1. Promoters shall submit proof of a surety bond to the Director in an amount equal to both the amount of purses and official fees as determined by the Director before a scheduled event.

- a. All bonds must be current and list the office of Combative Sports as the obligee.
- b. Bonds must be verified and approved by the Director.
- c. Failure to comply may result in the cancellation of the event and disciplinary action.

F. INSURANCE REQUIREMENTS

1. Promoters are required to provide participants with at least \$10,000 of life insurance covering deaths caused by injuries sustained during a bout.
2. Promoters are required to provide participants in each event with at least \$10,000 of insurance coverage for medical, surgical, and hospital care as a result of injuries sustained during a bout.
3. Promoters are required to provide the Director with proof of the above insurance coverage at least seven days prior to the scheduled event. Failure to provide timely proof may result in cancellation of the event and/or disciplinary action.

G. APPROVED ANNOUNCEMENTS

1. Promoters are responsible for ensuring that an announcement is made prior to the start of the main event which includes a statement that the event is regulated by the Commission.
2. Other announcements must be limited to those pertaining to present and future permitted bouts unless additional information in the announcement is specifically authorized by the Director or chief inspector.
3. Political announcements or references are not allowed under any circumstances.

H. SUBSTITUTION ANNOUNCEMENTS

Promoters are required to publicly announce all substitutions for participants advertised for bouts as soon as the substitutions are known. Prior to the announcement of a substitution, the substitute participant must be approved by Director or the chief inspector. If the substitute appears for the bouts and is not used for any reason other than medical disqualification, the substitute will be reimbursed by the promoter a minimum of one hundred dollars for training expenses and transportation. Failing to announce substitutions or pay the required reimbursement may result in disciplinary action against the promoter.

I. DELAY OF BOUTS

Promoters are responsible for having participants ready to enter the ring or cage immediately after the conclusion of the preceding bout. Any promoter causing a delay of more than five minutes may be subject to disciplinary action.

J. SECURITY AT EVENTS

The promoter is responsible for working with owner or operator of the premises in which the event and weigh-in is held to ensure that adequate security is provided for the participants and other persons who are present.

1.14 REQUIREMENTS FOR CONTRACT, FINANCIAL ARRANGEMENTS AND REPORTING FRAUD

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. CONTRACT BETWEEN THE PROMOTERS AND THE PARTICIPANT – WRITING REQUIRED

No professional bout will be approved without a contract with the promoter and the participant. The contracts must contain a minimum of the following:

1. Name and signature of promoter or an authorized designee of the promoter.
2. Name and signature of participant.
3. Name of the opponent.
4. Type of Bout.
5. Date and start time of the event.
6. Date and start time of weigh-in.
7. Location of event and weigh-in.
8. Number of rounds in the bout.
9. Time limit of each round.
10. Maximum and minimum weight allowable.
11. Purse amount (Includes show and win money and ticket amount given), including a statement identifying the form of purse payment.
12. Statement that failure to make contract weight will result in a fine of twenty (20) percent of their compensation that distributed to the opponent, as well as twenty (20) percent of all bonuses (including win bonuses) to the opponent.
13. Statement that participant will be present and on time to the weigh-in and the event.
14. Statements that the purse may be held by the Commission for violations.
15. Any deducted fees must be listed (this does not include Commission permit or license fees).
16. Statement that indicates participants will be paid by the promoter immediately following the event.
17. Statement that indicates a substitute participant will be paid by the promoter if they do not engage in a bout.
18. Statement whereby the participant acknowledges the inherent risk of engaging in the sport. The participant, agrees to waive any claim that they or the participant's heirs may have against the State of Colorado, or any of its employees or official representatives as the result of any injury the participant may suffer while engaging in any bout.

B. All contracts subject to this rule shall be available for inspection prior to the event date by the Director.

C. Promoters must disclose to the Commission, in writing, fight purse amounts, which may include any bonuses that are paid out.

D. **MAXIMUM EFFORT**

A participant shall not be fully paid a fee who does not complete the terms of the contract or compete in good faith or maximum effort during the bout as determined by the Director or chief inspector.

E. **VIOLATION OF CONTRACT**

Violation of the terms of a contract by any party may be grounds for disciplinary action.

F. **GUIDELINES FOR REPORTS OF FRAUD**

1. If any person has reason to believe that fraud has occurred, such person must report the issue to the Director in writing within ten days of the event, unless otherwise extended by the Director.
2. Any licensee who fails to report to the Director any fraud, violation of the law or rule may be subject to disciplinary action.
3. If a licensee is approached with a request or suggestion that an event is not conducted honestly, that licensee must immediately report the matter to the Director. Failure to do so may be subject to disciplinary action.
4. Any licensee, who directly or indirectly holds, participates in, aids or abets any sham or fake contest or match may be subject to disciplinary action.

1.15 PERSONNEL, FACILITY AND EQUIPMENT REQUIREMENTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S. Promoters and others involved in an event have the responsibility to understand and comply with the following Rules.

A. **PERSONNEL REQUIRED DURING BOUTS**

1. **Physician**
 - a. A bout shall not start or continue unless the physician(s) are actively licensed in Colorado, approved for the event, is seated at ring or cage side, and the physician shall not leave until after the decision in a final bout.
 - b. Televised bouts may require two physicians so that bouts may continue as one physician attends to a participant in the dressing rooms or in the near proximity.
 - c. Physicians shall be prepared to assist if any serious emergency arises, and shall render temporary or emergency treatments for cuts and minor injuries sustained by the participants.
2. **Emergency Medical Technician (EMT)**

- a. Promoters are responsible for ensuring that all bouts have a minimum of two EMT's onsite and must ensure that the EMT's have medical equipment that at a minimum contains the following items and is located within twelve feet of the ring or cage:
 - (1) A resuscitator;
 - (2) An oxygen tank properly charged with suitable masks;
 - (3) A stretcher;
 - (4) An airway.
 - b. Promoters must arrange for an ambulance to be onsite throughout the entire event and must arrange for and give advance notice to the nearest hospital and persons in charge of its emergency room of such event.
 - c. The Director may require additional medical equipment and personnel as appropriate.
3. Security
- a. Promoters are responsible for ensuring that public safety is maintained at all events by hiring a minimum of one certified peace officer.
 - b. Additional officers may be required as determined by the Director.
 - c. Any peace officer hired for this purpose must be Colorado State certified and must be employed by the local agency having jurisdiction in that area.
 - d. The decision of whether a uniform is not worn by the peace officer shall be a joint decision of the law enforcement agency and the Director.
 - e. Failure to comply may result in the cancellation of the event and may result in disciplinary action.

B. FACILITY REQUIREMENTS

Promoters are responsible for ensuring that all local laws and fire codes are adhered to where an event occurs. Additionally, promoters are responsible for ensuring that the facility selected for the event and the weigh-in is a family-friendly environment. Facility selection is subject to the approval of the Director or chief inspector.

1. Dressing Rooms

- a. Promoters are responsible for limiting the dressing room area to authorized personnel and shall furnish a person to enforce this limitation.
- b. Female weigh-in participants may request separate dressing rooms from male participants.
- c. The promoter shall furnish a private room for officials at the event.
- d. The dressing rooms and immediate area must:

- (1) Provide privacy for the participants;
- (2) Be properly lighted;
- (3) Be clean and free of clutter, trash, etc.;
- (4) Be free of alcoholic beverages or illegal drugs;
- (5) Comply with local health department requirements.

2. Smoking area and Prohibited Objects

- a. Smoking is not permitted within twelve feet of the ring or cage.
- b. Beverages shall not be dispensed in cans or glass.
- c. Food or serving items used by the patrons shall not be made of hard substances that could reasonably cause harm if thrown.
- d. Any objects considered harmful to patrons as determined by Director or chief inspector are prohibited.

3. Ring, Cage, or Competition Area Safety Zone

A physical barrier surrounding the entire ring, cage, or competition area shall be placed at a minimum nine feet away from the outside edge of the apron or competition area. Anything within this area is the safety zone. The safety zone shall be under the control and jurisdiction of the Director or the chief inspector assigned to supervise the event.

- a. The safety zone is to be used for designated working officials, participants, seconds, physicians, announcers, Commission members and their guests and media representatives as approved by the Director or chief inspector.
- b. Promoters must ensure that the safety zone is controlled and free of nonessential individuals and the only beverage allowed is water.
- c. At no time during the bout may any items be on the ring apron.
- d. The tables next to the ring or cage must be free of any obstructions and shall not be higher than the fighting area platform. All areas surrounding the ring or cage must be suitable and safe as approved by the Director or chief inspector.
- e. Spectator seats shall be a minimum of ten feet away from the outside edge of the apron.
- f. The ring or cage safety zone must be completely set up at least three hours prior to the start of the first bout. This includes properly tightened ropes and all necessary equipment at ring or cage side.

C. RING AND CAGE REQUIREMENTS

1. Ring and Cage Size

- a. The ring shall be not less than 16 feet nor more than 25 feet square within the ropes. The ring must have three sets of suitable steps. It shall be elevated no less than three and one-half feet nor more than four feet from the floor.
- b. The cage shall be not less than 18 feet nor more than 32 feet square within the fighting area. The cage must have a set of suitable steps for each entrance. It shall be elevated no more than four feet from the floor.
- c. The ring or cage posts shall be made of metal not less than three inches or more than four inches in diameter extending from the floor to the height of 58 inches above the ring floor.
- d. The ring or cage entry onto the fighting area canvas must be sufficient to allow easy access to the fighting area.

2. Ring Ropes and Fencing

- a. Four ropes are required for boxing and kickboxing. The lower rope shall be 18 inches above the ring floor, the second rope 30 inches, the third rope 42 inches, and the fourth rope 54 inches above the ring floor. The ropes shall not be less than one inch in diameter and wrapped in soft material, with the corners padded with protective covers.
- b. A fifth or bottom rope is required for MMA bouts in a ring. The bottom rope shall not be more than six inches from the ring floor. The requirements for the top four ropes are the same as for boxing and kickboxing.
- c. The fencing that encloses a cage shall be made of materials that will not allow a participant to easily fall out of the space or break through it onto the floor or spectators.
- d. Acceptable materials for ring ropes or fencing include but are not limited to:
 - (1) Vinyl-coated chain link fencing;
 - (2) Metal parts of the enclosure and fighting that are covered and padded;
 - (3) Any material that is not abrasive to the participants;
 - (4) Any material that does not obstruct or limit the supervision and regulation of the bout.
- e. The ropes shall be connected to the posts with extensions not shorter than 18 inches.
- f. All ring ropes and fencing is subject to the approval of the Director or the chief inspector.

3. Materials for the Ring and Cage Floor

- a. Floor.
 - (1) The ring floor shall extend beyond the lower rope no less than 24 inches.

- (2) The entire floor and apron must be padded with insulate, felt, matting, or a similar material with a thickness of at least one-inch.
- (3) A canvas or similar material covering, stretched tightly and laced or fastened to the outer edge of the floor shall cover the padding.
- (4) Boards shall be of sufficient strength to hold the weight and ensure the safety of all who enter the ring.
- (5) The padding thickness of any material is subject to the approval of the Director.

b. Prohibited Floor Materials.

- (1) Vinyl or any plastic rubberized covering.
- (2) Materials that gather in lumps or ridges.

4. Additional Required Equipment

Promoters are required to provide all equipment and materials necessary to conduct all bouts. The equipment must be clean and in good condition. Such required equipment includes which are subject examination and approval by a Commission representative the following:

- a. Steps;
- b. Two similar stools;
- c. Water buckets;
- d. Bell;
- e. Buzzer or whistle;
- f. Timers;
- g. Gloves;
- h. Head gear;
- i. Elbow pads;
- j. Shin pads;
- k. Gauze and tape;
- l. Scale;
- m. Any other associated material and equipment as determined by the Director.

5. Pairs of Gloves Required for all competing participants.

Promoters are responsible for having pairs of gloves on hand equal to the number of participants competing. The gloves may be used multiple times during an event. Promoters must be prepared for differing glove sizes.

6. Gloves

All gloves shall be furnished by the promoter and shall be new or in-tact and in good clean condition without lumps or imperfections. All participants in the main event, championship bouts and bouts of six rounds or more shall use new gloves. The specific glove size for each event shall be as follows:

- a. In boxing, Muay Thai, or kickboxing bouts, the following requirements apply:
 - (1) Participants weighing 147 pounds or less shall use at least eight-ounce gloves.
 - (2) Participants weighing over 147 pounds shall use at least ten-ounce gloves.
 - (3) When two participants differ in weight classes, participants shall use at least ten-ounce gloves.
 - (4) The Director may approve or require glove size increases.
 - (5) Participants in each bout shall wear the same brand gloves. The Director may approve gloves of different -brands.
- b. In MMA bouts, the following requirements apply:
 - (1) Gloves must weigh at least four ounces.
 - (2) Gloves weighing over eight ounces must be approved by the Director or the chief inspector.
- c. All gloves will be examined and approved by the Director or the chief inspector any time before, during and after a bout.
- d. If gloves are not approved by the Director or the chief inspector, they will be discarded before the bout starts, and the bout will not proceed until proper gloves are approved.
- e. Gloves that are manipulated in such a manner as breaking, skinning, roughing or twisting shall not be approved for use, and such conduct is subject to disciplinary action.

1.16 TICKETS AND SALES REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to section 12-110-107, C.R.S.

A. ADMISSION TO EVENTS AND TICKETS REQUIRED

- 1. Every person admitted to an event shall have a ticket or a pass, complimentary or otherwise. Officials, participants, and seconds do not require a ticket or a pass. Every admission ticket or complimentary ticket or pass must be tracked.

2. The retail price of the tickets shall be printed in large type and displayed prominently above or near all ticket sellers or ticket windows.
3. The promoter shall disclose the retail ticket prices to the Director no later than the time the application for the permit is filed.
4. Tickets of different prices shall be printed in different colors, or state the retail price on the face value of the ticket. Retail ticket prices shall not be changed.
5. The Director shall be provided with all information and materials necessary for an accurate accounting, including the printers' manifest showing the total number of tickets printed and the admission prices of each within seven days of an event.
6. Advance tickets, as well as tickets sold at the time of the event, must be accounted for as part of the gross receipts.
7. The number of tickets sold shall not exceed the actual capacity of the location or facility where the event is to be held.

B. OTHER TICKETS AND TICKET LIMIT

The Director, Commissioners, chief inspectors, and designated employees of the Department of Regulatory Agencies shall be admitted without charge to any event over which the Commission has jurisdiction. These individuals may be required to present their state identification.

C. NOTICE OF CHANGE - TICKET REFUNDS

1. Notice of any change in the announced advertised bouts must be conspicuously posted at the box office and announced prior to the scheduled start of the bouts.
2. Any patrons requesting a refund of the ticket price must present the tickets or the ticket stubs at the box office or to a designated person who is handling the refunds.
3. All returned ticket stubs must be held for an accurate accounting of the gross receipts.

D. SURCHARGE

The promoter is responsible for all surcharge matters below:

1. An event surcharge on gross receipts, less applicable taxes, may be assessed on each event. If tickets or passes are priced so that the applicable surcharge results in less than \$1.00 per ticket or pass, a surcharge of \$1.00 per ticket or pass may be assessed.
2. An additional surcharge may be assessed on each ticket or pass issued to the event as determined by the Division Director.
3. No later than ten business days after the event, promoters are responsible for filing an accurate surcharge report with the appropriate surcharge payment. Payment shall be in the form of a cashier's check, money order, or other acceptable methods as determined by the Director.
4. The Director has the discretion to verify the surcharge report submitted.
5. Failing to submit an accurate surcharge report and appropriate payment may result in disciplinary action.

1.17 REQUIREMENTS FOR ELIMINATION BOUTS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant 12-110-107, C.R.S.

Rules 1.5, 1.6, 1.8, 1.9, and 1.10 apply to elimination bouts unless otherwise noted in this Rule.

A. ELIGIBILITY

1. A participant is eligible to compete if they have NOT been a competitor in professional combative sports.
2. Promoters are required to call to the attention of the Director any concerns. The Director may not accept a participant due to conduct or safety concerns. The Director will determine whether the fighter is fit to continue.

B. ELIMINATION GLOVE SIZE

1. For all boxing, kickboxing, and Muay Thai elimination bouts, boxing gloves of at least 12 ounces shall be worn.
2. For all MMA elimination bouts, gloves of a least four ounces shall be worn.

C. EQUIPMENT

1. Boxing:

The Promoter shall provide head gear which shall be worn by all participants. The Director has the sole discretion to waive the headgear requirement on a bout by bout basis.

2. Kickboxing:

The promoter shall provide headgear, shin guards, which shall be worn by all participants. The Director has the discretion to limit the amount of equipment required.

3. Muay Thai:

The promoter shall provide headgear, shin guards, and elbow pads, which shall be worn by all participants unless modified under Rule 1.16(l). Only elbow pads approved by the Director shall be used.

D. ROUNDS AND TIME LENGTH

1. With Director approval, elimination boxing, kickboxing, and Muay Thai bouts may consist of three, three-minute rounds with a one-minute rest period between rounds.
2. Elimination MMA bouts shall consist of three, three-minute rounds with a one-minute rest period between each round.

E. ELIMINATION TOURNAMENT FORMAT

1. Tournaments shall be single elimination events. A participant who has lost a bout may not participate in another bout in the same event.
2. Tournaments may be between only two participants.

F. ELIMINATION TOURNAMENT LENGTH

1. Elimination tournaments are a one-day event. Participants may not participate in more than three matches per event.

G. WEIGHT CLASSES

1. The following shall be the weight classes by each sport:
 - a. Boxing: Rule 1.8
 - b. Kickboxing: Rule 1.9
 - c. Muay Thai: Rule 1.9
 - d. Mixed Martial Arts: The Commission adopts by reference the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports Unified Rules of Mixed Martial Arts regarding weight categories (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)).

The standards and regulations incorporated by reference may be examined at the Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado 80202, during normal business hours, Monday through Friday, except when such days are state holidays. Certified copies of the incorporated standards shall be provided at cost upon request. The Director or the Director's designee will provide information regarding how the incorporated standards and regulations may be examined at any state public depository library. The standards and regulations are also available from the agency, organization or association originally issuing the code, standard, guideline or rules as follows: Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)) and the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing> (effective July 26, 2017)).

This Rule does not include any later amendments or editions of the code, standard, guideline, or rules.

H. ELIMINATION RULES FOR BOXING, KICKBOXING, MUAY THAI AND MIXED MARTIAL ARTS

1. Unless specifically modified elsewhere under these rules, the Commission adopts the Boxing rules starting in Rule 1.8.
2. Unless specifically modified elsewhere under these rules, the Commission adopts by reference the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports Unified Rules of Amateur Kickboxing (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-of-amateur-kickboxing/>)(effective July 29, 2019))
3. Unless specifically modified elsewhere under these rules, the Commission adopts the Muay Thai rules starting in Rule 1.9.

4. Unless specifically modified elsewhere under these rules, the Commission adopts by reference the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports Unified Rules of Mixed Martial Arts (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)).

The standards and regulations incorporated by reference may be examined at the Colorado Office of Combative Sports and Colorado Combative Sports Commission, 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, Colorado 80202, during normal business hours, Monday through Friday, except when such days are state holidays. Certified copies of the incorporated standards shall be provided at cost upon request. The Director or the Director's designee will provide information regarding how the incorporated standards and regulations may be examined at any state public depository library. The standards and regulations are also available from the agency, organization or association originally issuing the code, standard, guideline or rules as follows: Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/unified-mma-rules-rev-july-2024.pdf> (effective November 1, 2024)) and the Association of Boxing Commissions and Combative Sports (<https://www.abcboxing.com/unified-rules-kickboxing> (effective July 26, 2017)). This Rule does not include any later amendments or editions of the code, standard, guideline, or rules.

I. ELBOW AND KNEE STRIKES PROHIBITED

Knee strikes to the head are prohibited in any elimination bout and the participant may be disqualified and subject to disciplinary action. Elbows to the head are prohibited in an elimination Muay Thai bout with the following exceptions:

1. Participants with 0-3 fights are required to wear all protective gear including headgear and shin guards. No elbows are allowed.
2. Participants with 4-9 fights are required to wear all protective gear including headgear, shin guards, and elbow pads.
3. Participants with 10 or more fights may wear all protective gear but shall wear elbow pads.
4. If elbow pads are used, they must be securely fashioned in such a manner to prevent slipping or the elbow pad from turning. White athletic tape may be used to secure both the top and bottom of the elbow pad.
5. Should an elbow pad come loose, the referee will immediately secure the elbow pad before allowing the bout to continue.

1.18 REQUIREMENTS FOR OFFICIALS

This Rule is promulgated pursuant to sections 12-20-105, 12-20-202(4), 12-110-107, 12-110-109, and 12-110-111, C.R.S.

A. OFFICIALS - CONTROL

1. All officials involved in an event shall be under the direct control and supervision of the Director or the chief inspector assigned to supervise the event. The Director has the discretion to determine whether clothes, facial or body adornments (long mustaches, goatees, beards sideburns) and length of hair comply with the professional dress code for officials for that particular event.

2. The bell shall only ring after the count is finished and the referee makes the determination the participant is able to continue or stops the bout.
3. The official may not consume, or be under the influence of, alcohol, marijuana, or any controlled substance while acting as an official.
4. Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action and prohibition from officiating future events.
5. Any written complaint made to the Director regarding officiating conduct, or officials conduct during and outside of an event, will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis if reported within two weeks after an event or incident.

B. MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS FOR AN OFFICIAL LICENSE

A license is required to serve as an official in a professional combative sport contest. All officials shall submit an application for a license to officiate in a manner prescribed by the Director. Incomplete or incorrect applications will not be accepted.

Each applicant for a license shall pay the fee established by the Division Director pursuant to section 12-20-105, C.R.S. Any person wishing to apply for an official's license must demonstrate the following qualifications in combative sport.

1. Referee Qualifications:
 - a. Referee experience may be demonstrated by one of the following:
 - (1) Four years of amateur experience as a referee at the highest classification level, or,
 - (2) One year of professional experience as a referee from a State Athletic Commission, or a Tribal Commission that is a member of the Association of Boxing Commissions.
 - b. Other requirements for Referees:
 - (1) Prior to licensure, a referee must attest that they have read and understand the laws and rules covering professional combative sports in this state.
 - (2) The referee must also read and understand the rules of the various sanctioning bodies.
 - (3) A written test and a physical examination may be required at the discretion of the Director to determine fitness to perform.
2. Judge Qualifications:
 - a. Judge experience may be demonstrated by one of the following:
 - (1) Three years of amateur experience as a judge at the highest level of accomplishment.

- (2) One year of professional experience as a judge from a State Athletic Commission or a Tribal Commission that is a member of the Association of Boxing Commissions.

3. Inspector Qualifications:

There are three positions within the inspector category: timekeepers, tally judge and knock down judge.

- a. Inspector experience may be demonstrated by one of the following:

- (1) Three years of amateur experience as an inspector, timekeeper, tally judge or knock down judge.
- (2) One year of professional experience in any of the positions listed above from a State Athletic Commission or a Tribal Athletic Commission that is a member of the Association of Boxing Commissions, or upon approval of the Director.

4. Credit for Military, Education, Training, or Experience

- a. An applicant for licensure may submit information about the applicant's education, training, or experience acquired during military service. It is the applicant's responsibility to provide timely and complete information for the Director's review.
- b. In order to meet the requirements for licensure, such education, training, or experience must be substantially equivalent to the required qualifications that are otherwise applicable at the time the application is received by the Director.
- c. The Director will determine, on a case-by-case basis, whether the applicant's military education, training, or experience meet the requirements for licensure.
- d. If the Director determines that the submitted military education, training, or experience only partially satisfies licensure requirements, the Director will advise the applicant on the amount and type of additional education, training, or experience that is required to qualify for licensure.
- e. Documentation of military experience may include, but is not limited to, Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty (DD-214), Verification of Military Experience and Training (DD-2586), Military transcript, Training records, Evaluation reports, or Letters from Commanding Officers describing the applicant's practice as an official.

C. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

- 1. Officials may not act in any other capacity during an event, unless given permission by the Director.
- 2. Officials shall be excluded from officiating as a referee or a judge in any bout involving participants with whom they have worked as manager, trainer, or had a recent business relationship.
- 3. Officials shall notify the Director or chief inspector immediately of any conflict or potential conflict in writing and as set forth in policy.

D. CHIEF INSPECTOR DEFINITION AND DUTIES

1. A chief inspector is a licensed official who is authorized by the Director to supervise an event on behalf of the Office of Combative Sports.
2. The Director shall set the amount of compensation the official will receive for each supervised event.
3. The chief inspector must ensure that the laws and rules are properly applied and enforced.
4. Chief inspectors must report to the Director any violations of the law or rule that occur during an event within twenty-four hours.

E. REFEREE ENFORCEMENT

1. The referee is charged with the enforcement of all Office of Combative Sports Rules which apply to the execution of performance and the conduct of participants' seconds while in the ring.
2. Referees shall not wear glasses of any kind while refereeing a bout.

F. REFEREE DUTIES

1. Before the start of each bout, the referee will check each judge and the timekeeper to determine if they are prepared to start the bout.
2. The referee is responsible for determining who will act as the chief second in each corner and shall hold them responsible for all conduct in the corners.
3. The referee in their discretion shall warn the seconds of rule violations, and if they do not comply, the referee shall warn them that further violations will result in point deductions, disqualification of their participant, and subject to disciplinary action.
4. The referee shall instruct the judges to mark their scorecards accurately at all times.
5. The referee shall ensure that a bout moves to its proper conclusion. It should not be stopped or delayed, except in cases of damaging fouls or health and safety concerns.
6. The referee shall penalize participants who delay or use avoiding tactics by deducting points or by immediate disqualification.
7. At the conclusion of all bouts and upon the announcement of the winner, the referee shall raise the winner's hand.

G. APPROVAL AND PAYMENT

The Director shall select the referee for each bout and the decision shall be final. The amount of money paid to the referee shall be fixed by the Director. Depending on the bout, a referee may be paid by the promoter or sanctioning organization.

H. SOLE ARBITER

1. The referee is the sole arbiter of a bout and is the only individual authorized to stop a bout.

2. Referees shall stop a bout when they deem the following:
 - a. The physical condition of a participant so requires,
 - b. When a participant is out-classed;
 - c. A participant is not demonstrating their best efforts.
3. In the event of serious cuts, the referee may seek a recommendation from the physician whether the bout should be stopped.

I. FORFEITURE AND WITHHOLDING OF A PARTICIPANT'S PURSE

The referee shall recommend to the Director or chief inspector, the forfeiture or the withholding of half of a participant's purse whenever a participant fails to perform in good faith or maximum effort when competing.

J. GLOVE INSPECTION

1. The referee shall inspect the gloves of the participants in all events and make sure that no foreign substances have been applied to the gloves or bodies of the participants that might be detrimental to an opponent.
2. Whenever the gloves of a boxing or kickboxing participant touches the canvas floor, the referee shall inspect the gloves and wipe them clean before the bout proceeds.

K. LOSS OF BODILY FUNCTION

If a participant, during a round, visibly loses control of a bodily function (vomit, urine, bowels), the bout shall be stopped by the referee, and the participant shall lose the contest by TKO. In the event a loss of control of a bodily function occurs in the rest period between rounds, the ringside physician shall be called in to evaluate if the combatant can continue. If the participant is not cleared by the ringside physician to continue, that participant shall lose by TKO. In these situations, the result shall be recorded as TKO due to Medical Stoppage.

L. KNOCKDOWN COUNTS

1. When a participant is knocked down as a result of a punch in a boxing bout or a legal kick or punch in a kickboxing bout, the referee shall order the opponent to a neutral corner and may pick up the count from the timekeeper.
2. The referee shall audibly announce the passing of the count. The participant may take the eight count either on the floor or standing. The referee's count is the official count.
3. Should the opponent fail to stay in the neutral corner, the referee shall cease the count until the participant returns to the corner, then the referee shall continue with the count from the point at which the count was interrupted.
4. The eight count is mandatory for a knockdown in a boxing and Muay Thai bout and a participant may not resume fighting until the referee has finished counting to eight.
5. During any count, the opponent shall go to the farthest neutral corner and remain in that neutral corner until signaled by the referee.

M. FALLEN PARTICIPANT WHO RISES AND FALLS AGAIN WITHOUT BEING HIT AGAIN

1. When a fallen participant rises and falls again, without being hit again, in a boxing, kickboxing, or Muay Thai bout the referee shall continue the original count, rather than starting a new count.
2. The bell shall only ring after the count is finished and the referee makes the determination the participant is able to continue or stops the bout.

N. COUNT OF TEN - INDICATION OF KNOCKOUT

If the referee calls the count of ten during a knockdown in a boxing, kickboxing, or Muay Thai bout or the referee determines that a participant is not able to continue, the referee shall wave both arms to indicate a knockout.

O. PARTICIPANTS DOWN AT THE SAME TIME

If both participants are considered down at the same time in a boxing or kickboxing bout, the count shall continue as long as one of them is still down. If both participants remain down until the count of ten, the bout shall be stopped and the result shall be a technical draw.

P. ASSESSING FOULS

1. The referee must weigh the cause as well as the act in assessing fouls.
2. When a foul is unintentionally inflicted, but intentionally received, it is applied to the deliberate recipient.
3. If a participant receives a low blow as determined by the referee, the referee may use their discretion to permit a rest period for the recipient. Such period shall not exceed five minutes. During the rest period, seconds may not assist or coach either participant.
4. The offending participant shall go to a neutral corner.
5. The referee will give a warning for a low blow to the offending participant if the participant who received the low blow indicates they are ready to continue the bout.
6. The referee will give the command to continue after the end of the rest period. If the offended participant refuses to continue after the rest period, their opponent may be named the winner.

Q. LOW BLOWS - RECIPIENT NAMED WINNER

A participant cannot be named the winner of a bout as a result of receiving a low blow unless the referee determines the blow was delivered deliberately and was of such force to seriously incapacitate the offended participant so that they could not continue to compete. Under this condition, the offender shall be disqualified immediately.

R. DELIBERATE ACTIONS TO GAIN ADVANTAGE – PENALTIES

1. The referee shall warn or penalize participants who use the ropes or deliberately dislodge their mouthpiece or use other unfair tactics to gain an advantage.
2. The referee shall not permit unfair tactics that may cause injuries to participants.

3. In a boxing bout, the only fair blow is a blow delivered with the padded knuckle part of the glove on the front or sides of the head and body above the hip line.

S. JUDGE APPROVAL

The Director shall select the judges for each bout and the decision shall be final. The amount of money paid the judges for services rendered shall be fixed by the Director. Depending on the bout, a judge may be paid by the promoter or sanctioning organization.

T. JUDGE DUTIES

1. Judges are responsible to familiarize themselves with and review the method to be used when scoring bouts which may vary by sport.
2. The bouts shall be scored to determine the winner with the ten-point must system. In this system, the winner of each round receives ten points and the opponent a proportionately lower number. If the round is even, each participant receives ten points.
3. Scorecards are provided by the Director and only those shall be used.
4. Each judge shall accurately complete their scorecard and in accordance with the provisions of the rules governing the sport they are judging.
5. At the end of each round the scorecard shall be totaled and signed by each judge.

U. NUMBER OF JUDGES

All bouts will be evaluated and scored by a minimum of three judges.

V. JUDGE POSITION

The judges shall sit alone at ring or cage side and will reach their own decision without conferring in any manner with any other official or person.

W. REMOVAL OF JUDGES

Judges of bouts will be under the control and jurisdiction of the office of Combative Sports. The Director or chief inspector reserves the right to remove a judge, if, the judge is inefficient or is otherwise unable to act as a judge.

X. INSPECTOR PERFORMING TIMEKEEPER DUTIES

The timekeeper is responsible for keeping accurate time of all bouts. The timekeeper shall keep an exact record of the time taken out at the request of the referee for the examination of a participant by the physician, replacing a glove, or adjusting equipment during a round, and report the exact time of the bout being stopped. The timekeeper shall use an audible device to indicate the conclusion of every round.

Editor's Notes

History

Rule 1.018 emer. rule eff. 09/24/2010; expired eff. 01/22/2011.

Entire rule eff. 09/01/2011.

Rules 1.1, 1.5, 2.6, 2.8, 2.9, 2.11, 3.2, 3.6, 5.11, 7.6, 12.4, 13.2, 13.3, 14.1 eff. 07/01/2016.

Entire rule eff. 07/01/2018.

Rules 1.1, 1.2, 1.7, 1.8, 2.5, 2.9-2.20, 3.3, 3.4, 5.1, Chapters 6-7, rules 8.6-8.13, 11.3 D.ix, 13.2, 13.3, 13.7-13.9, 14.1, 14.15-14.17 emer. rules eff. 06/18/2019.

Rules 1.1, 1.2, 1.7, 1.8, 2.1, 2.5, 2.9-2.20, 3.3, 3.4, 5.1, 5.4, 6.1-6.5, 7.1, 7.2, 8.6-8.13, 10.1, 11.3, 12.2-12.4, 13.1-13.9, 14.1, 14.2 D, 14.15-14.17 eff. 12/30/2019.

Entire rule eff. 05/30/2021.

Rule 1.4 K.2 eff. 11/30/2021.

Rule 1.18 emer. rule eff. 10/12/2022.

Rules 1.3, 1.6 F.6, 1.8 B, 1.10 A, 1.11 A, 1.12 D.4.b, 1.12 E.1, 1.13 A.11, 1.14 C.6.a, 1.16 D.1, 1.16 G.1.d, 1.16 H.4, 1.17 U, 1.18 eff. 11/30/2022.

Rules 1.3, 1.4 A, 1.4 D, 1.4 F, 1.5 D.2, 1.5 E, 1.6 D-I, 1.7 F, 1.8 D, 1.8 O, 1.11-1.18 eff. 10/15/2024. Rule 1.18 repealed eff. 10/15/2024.

Rules 1.3, 1.9 A, 1.10 A, 1.17 G.1.d, 1.17 H.4 emer. rules eff. 11/01/2024.

Rules 1.3, 1.9 A, 1.10 A, 1.17 G.1.d, 1.17 H.4 emer. rules eff. 02/19/2025.

Rules 1.3, 1.9 A, 1.10 A, 1.17 G.1.d, 1.17 H.4 emer. rules eff. 06/03/2025.

Rules 1.3, 1.9 A, 1.10 A, 1.17 G.1.d, 1.17 H.4 eff. 07/30/2025.

Annotations

Rules 1.18 B. and 1.18 C. (adopted 10/12/2022) were not extended by Senate Bill 23-102 and therefore expired 05/15/2023.